Meet Darren.

He doesn't have all the answers.
But he's here to listen.



Learn how you can too.

Caring for Life

"If you see my appearance right, I guess the first impression may be quite intimidating..."


"...but my close friends have told me that I'm actually a gentle giant, like a teddy bear inside. So don't judge a book by its cover!"

"I guess it's in our culture, right, whether or not we can speak about suicide. Maybe in our culture it's still a taboo topic."



"One of my close friends lost her mother to cancer many years ago. At that point, she had thoughts of ending her life."

"At that point in time, I did not know how to help. Should I ask her to cheer up? Should I take away her pain of grieving her mother? Should I even talk about her suicidal thoughts?



"As a close friend, I don't think that we should not check in just because we are afraid to do so. I guess that would have more direct consequences than to ask and say something wrong."

"I spoke to that friend, and I realized that what she needed wasn't solutions, or someone to take away her pain, or to immediately be free from grief."



"What she needed was a pair of listening ears, and for others to acknowledge how she's feeling. And, most importantly, to be present with her, especially when she's grieving."

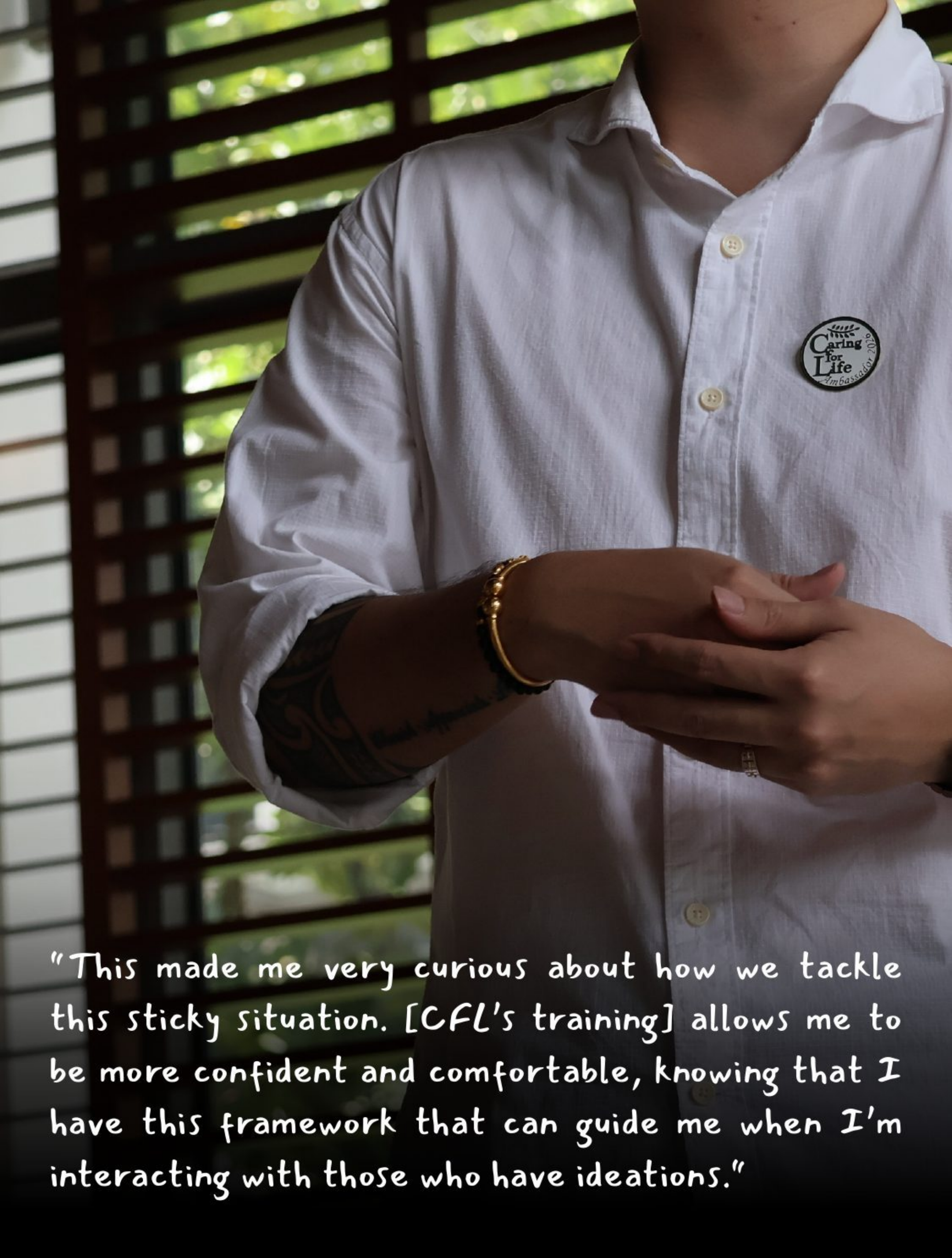


"There's a big misconception that we have to be experts to care for someone, or that you have to have a degree in psychology in order to help someone effectively. But you don't have to be an expert to care for someone, especially if that person is a loved one or friend."

"And we really have to cut the idea that we are here to problem-solve... Even with well intentions, we may end up dismissing how the other person is feeling. Maybe we can change that mindset to let's figure out how to deal with this together."



"Maybe we can change that mindset to let's figure out how to deal with this together."



"This made me very curious about how we tackle this sticky situation. [CFL's training] allows me to be more confident and comfortable, knowing that I have this framework that can guide me when I'm interacting with those who have ideations."

"But the main thing is that we don't have to have every solution in the world; we don't have to be an expert to care for someone. Just being present, acknowledging how they feel, and being there for them in this journey...



...I guess that is magic. And I guess that is enough."

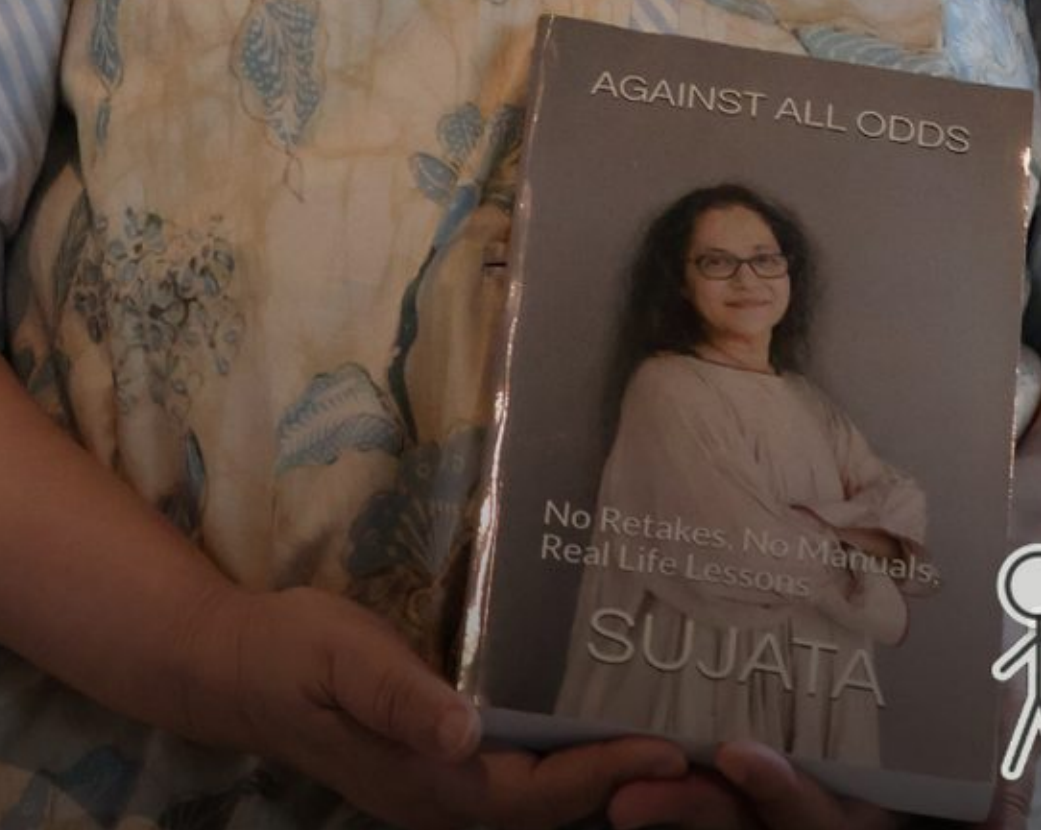
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Meet Sujata.

She doesn't have all the answers.
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"You know, we tend to look at the physical. We look at somebody and we make up our mind right, or we have opinions or perceptions that might not be true. Unless you get to know a person, you don't know what's inside.

"I've had all kinds of experiences. Whether you talk of bullying or harassment in the workplace, I've gone through that. Whether as a housewife with three children, or if you have been stalked by a mafia, what would you do?

So, anything in life that you can think of, I've gone through, except for being murdered. So that has shaped the resilience part of me."

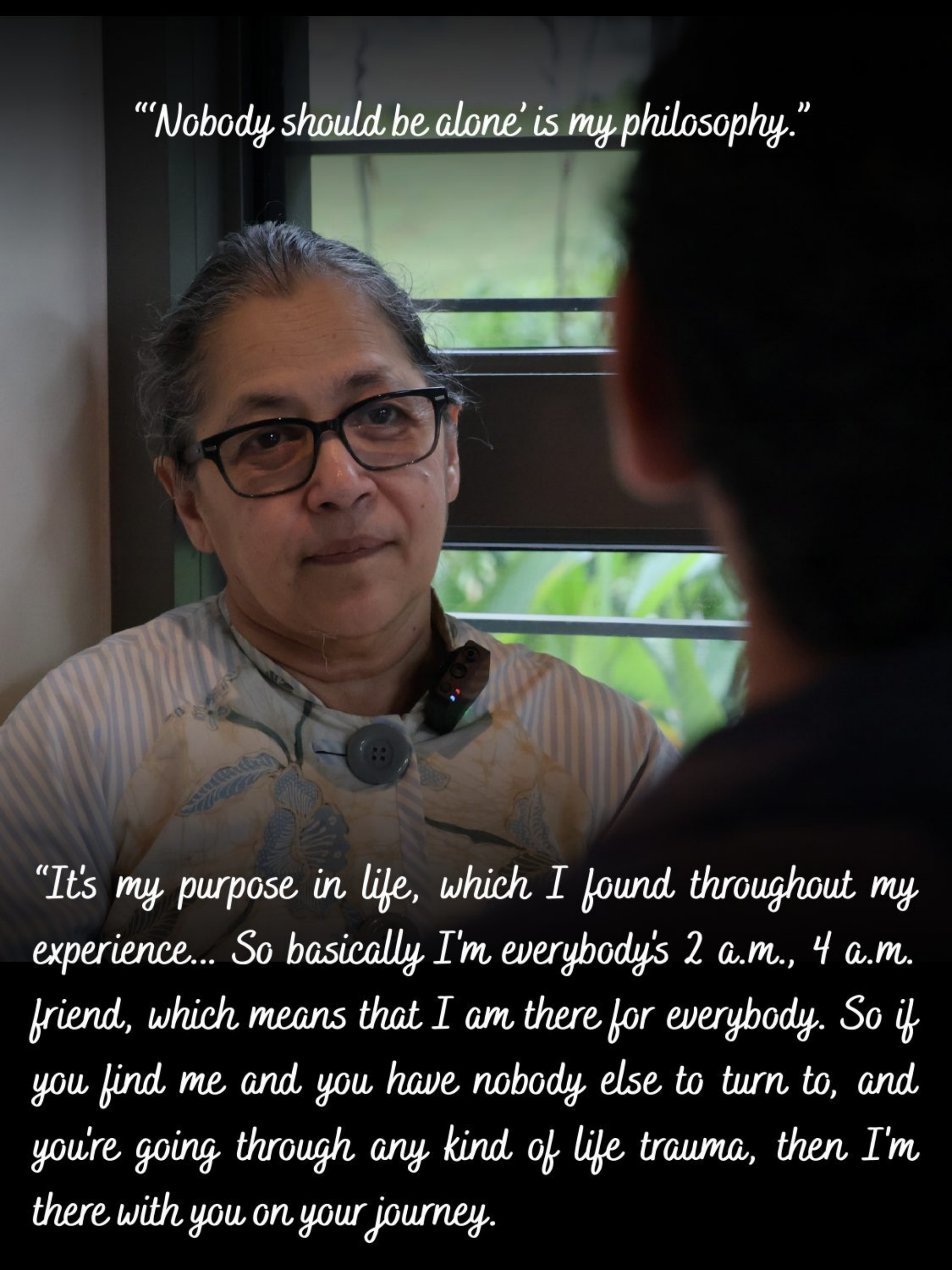


"This fat book is not just an ordinary book; it took me seven months to write non-stop, full-time. It's not easy to write and to revisit all your traumas and everything, right? And still put it as a positive learning thing for people to get inspired."



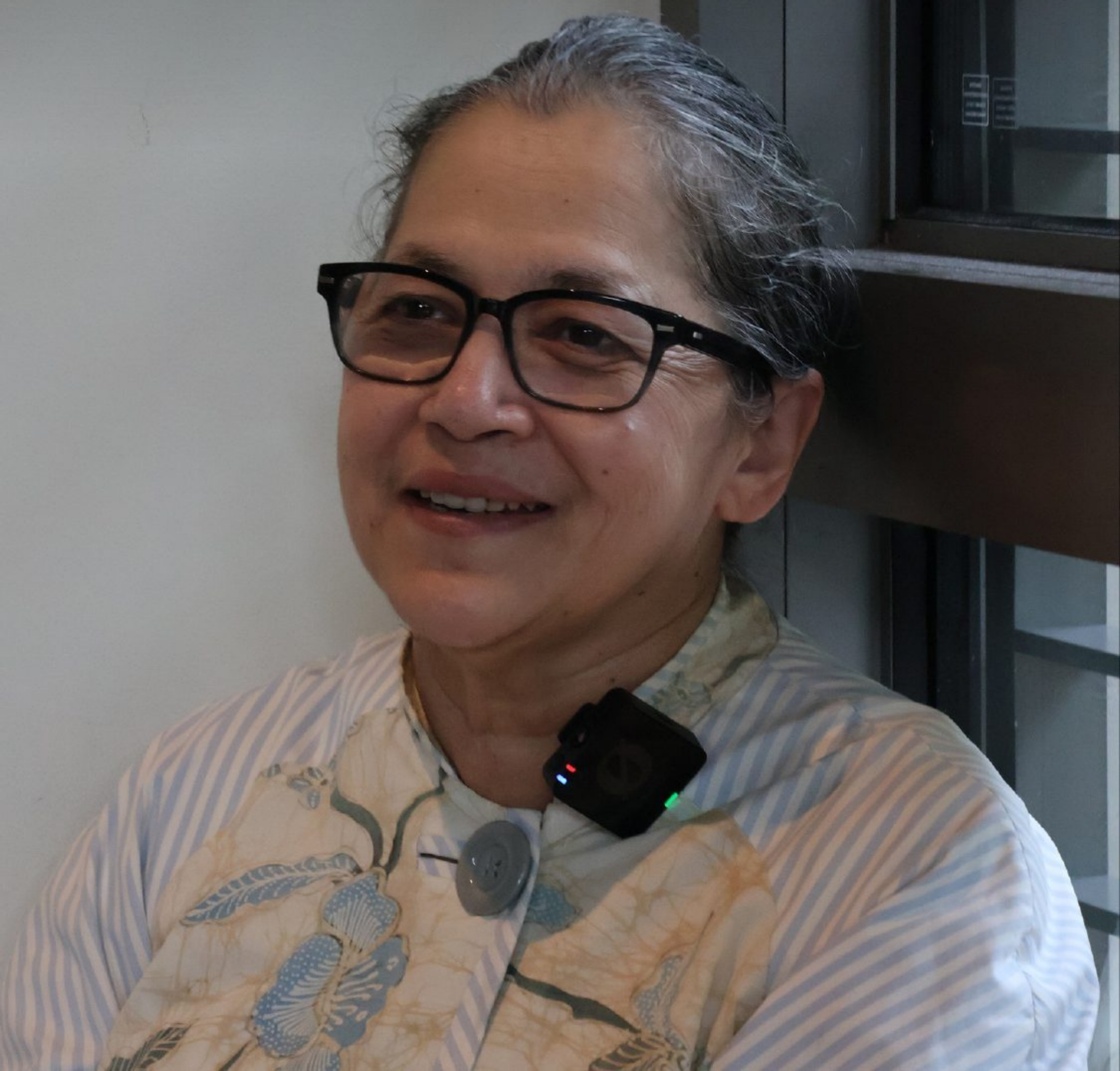
"In my book, when I was alone and had nobody in different phases of life, there were random strangers who came to my rescue who I called the human angels. As you go through your life, you will find that some random stranger would say, 'I'll help you.' And not the ones that you think would help. That's been at least my journey."





"It's my purpose in life, which I found throughout my experience... So basically I'm everybody's 2 a.m., 4 a.m. friend, which means that I am there for everybody. So if you find me and you have nobody else to turn to, and you're going through any kind of life trauma, then I'm there with you on your journey.

"There are times when I've stayed awake all night helping people who have been thinking of suicide to hold space for them. It makes a difference. Every life matters right? As CFL says also."





"I believe very strongly in Alex (CFL's founder) when he says suicide prevention is everybody's business. You don't have to be an expert. You should just care. So you never know whose life you can save if you just have a caring culture, personality, or that heart."



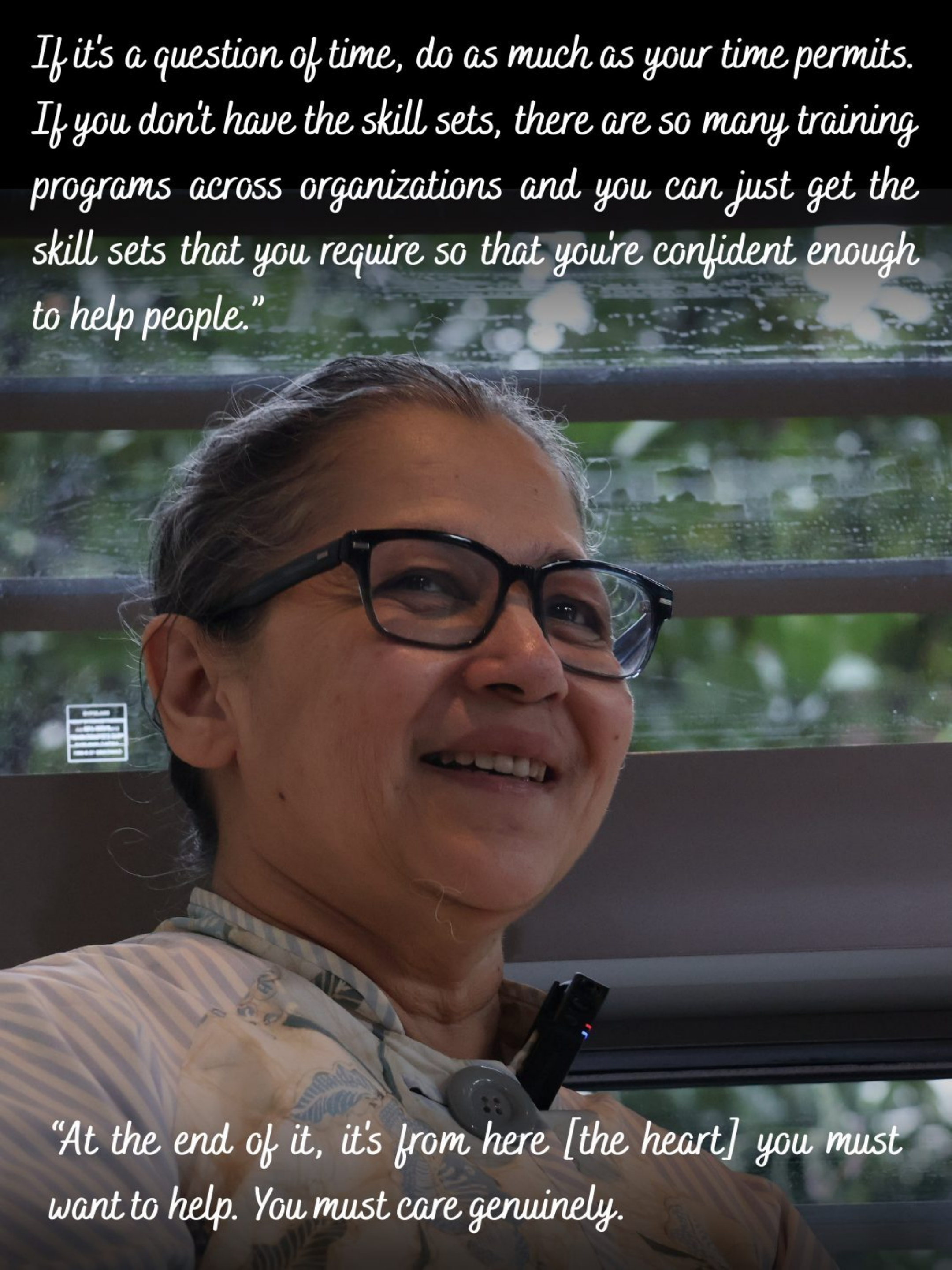
"We really have to build a society with better cultures of care. But people hesitate to help because of various reasons. They might not feel confident enough. They might not understand what expectations or what help is required."



"But you just need to have that caring heart. You can just be there for that person. You may not be able to do anything and everything for the person. But at least you can show the person that [they] matter. "

"Let me give you an analogy. It's like a garden, okay? You plant the seedlings; different trees, different plants grow, right? If you don't nurture it, they will not grow. But they will grow at their own speed, time, and the way the DNA of the plant is. That's the thing of care."

If it's a question of time, do as much as your time permits. If you don't have the skill sets, there are so many training programs across organizations and you can just get the skill sets that you require so that you're confident enough to help people."



"At the end of it, it's from here [the heart] you must want to help. You must care genuinely.

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